

20 SOMETHING
EPISODE I
PILOT

Written by

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CAST LIST

Edward – A restless romantic and self-aware dreamer who believes he's destined for something greater yet feels fractured by desire, memory, and the fear that he's already been shaped beyond repair.

Mere – Edward's loyal but enigmatic best friend, emotionally perceptive and quietly intense, someone who sees him clearly even when he can't see himself.

Spear – A confident, magnetic corps leader with physical presence and soft authority, carrying the kind of charisma that pulls people into his orbit without effort.

Young Edward – A lonely and searching version of Edward who once believed he could outrun his environment before realizing it was already shaping him.

Kacey – Edward's complicated love interest, strong and guarded, someone who represents both longing and distance at the same time.

Johnson – A corps boy shaped by structure and hierarchy, part of the disciplined world Edward is trying to understand and survive inside.

Tiff – Carolina's grounded confidante, likely practical and socially aware, serving as a stabilizing voice in Carolina's life.

Jinny – Edward's mother, warm and principled, representing the idealized stability of family he both trusts and quietly questions.

Trevor – Edward's father, steady and traditional, embodying the model of adulthood Edward feels pressure to live up to.

Jace – Edward's uncle, a peripheral but influential adult presence tied to family legacy and expectation.

Carolina – Spear's emotionally complicated partner, caught somewhere between attachment and uncertainty.

Riley – Another corps boy within Spear's structured world, reinforcing the collective pressure of belonging and conformity.

Nurse – A caretaker figure who signals moments of vulnerability, transition, or consequence in Edward's life.

INT. EDWARD'S ROOM - DAY

Everything is neatly put away. A single sheet of paper sits on the desk. Darkness penetrates the room. Thunder rolls in.

EDWARD (V.O.)

Come with me, to bury my sins. I'll bury yours too. You can watch me dig the grave. I'll strip in the summer, bare back against the breeze. They'll go in the garden. Deep in the soil where they'll never be seen. This is where bastards grow and disaster strikes. They said that boy's too lean. Pound that meat till his flesh is bloody and pink. They're asking for more from me, and I'm sorry. I'm a whore... No, my love isn't perfect. I'm a toy. Treat me as such, and I'll be kind in return. In return, I'll love you forever.

MERE (V.O.)

I love you.

SPEAR (V.O.)

I love you.

KACEY (V.O.)

I love you.

MERE (V.O.)

This is going to be an experience.

SPEAR (V.O.)

I'll take you wherever you want to be; whenever you want to go.

A soft patter of rain.

MERE (V.O.)

Those two. Unique boys. Their souls fans of one another from afar.

EDWARD (V.O.)

I'm afraid to ask, but won't you come with me?

MERE (V.O.)

For forever? A part of my collection.

KACEY (V.O.)

I don't know you. You're a shell of the boy I broke so long ago.

EDWARD
Won't you love me out there?

KACEY (V.O.)
Don't make me call you beautiful.
Not in front of these people.

EDWARD (V.O.)
Even though you are. But we can't
both be. Never at the same time.

MERE (V.O.)
Not in front of them.

KACEY (V.O.)
Reach for me out there when you get
where you're going. Given you've
got what you're getting.

EDWARD (V.O.)
I'll wake you up when this is all
over, after I've got it. And maybe
we will be so different after all.

CU: On a blank page.

EDWARD
There's an innate difference
between dreamers and realists. I'm
both. My dreams keep me from
sleeping in a world that cannot
possibly be real.

ZOOMING OUT OF THE PAGE: WE SEE THE BACK OF EDWARD'S (20)
HEAD. He wears a cool white t-shirt and short athletic
shorts. He hosts a mullet that's wild and all over the place.

EDWARD (CONT'D)
I like to think I have some say in
all of this.

He starts to write something down, hesitates, then swivels
around in his chair. At the door is TREVOR (50's) and JINNY
(45). Trevor holds onto Jinny at her waist.

EDWARD (CONT'D)
I'm destined to rise above it all,
but like everything in this life,
I'm mass produced and expedited. A
product of my people.

Two boys sit on opposite ends of a couch. SPEAR (21): what
everyone calls him. Tall, blonde, a close haircut, built
extremely well, and soft eyes that make you melt.

KACEY (20): a strong stature, filled out mostly in his chest. He's the trope of an army man. They look to one another, sharing what could be's with their smiles and secrets with their eyes.

EDWARD (CONT'D)

I'm a mosaic of my lovers, and no one's ever loved me. Glass always shatters so easily.

Edward turns to the bed where a girl drifts off atop a cloud. She looks innocent, like a sleeping baby. MERE (20): misplaced tattoos, striking eyes, and lush long hair. She's the definition of a woman. The masterpiece God created.

EDWARD (CONT'D)

I'm made up of wonderful things, and I'm not a wonderful person. Because where there is wonder, there is will, and there is wrongful.

He turns to look OUTSIDE: it's a real bitch. Dreary. Depressing. He's looking for something to wish on.

EDWARD (CONT'D)

I wish upon stars and always want more. Desires have damned me to walk this Earth for eternity.

He turns back to the couch. Spear and Kacey are gone.

EDWARD (CONT'D)

I'm jealously and injustices fueled by have not's and what should be's.

At the door, Trevor and Jinny are nowhere to be seen.

EDWARD (CONT'D)

I fear the forthcoming because of the happenings I've seen.

CUT TO BLACK.

Light arcs across. The definition of ominous and the damned. Thunder and heat lightning roll, the kind that chills you to the bone.

INT. EDWARD'S CHILDHOOD BEDROOM - TEN YEARS AGO

EDWARD (V.O.)

When I was younger, I used to wonder, how fucked up is this going to make me? I was invincible. I wasn't a consequence of my environment. These people weren't my family. The town I lived in wasn't my home. I was destined to be great and nothing I had experienced would ever debilitate me.

A phone comes to life and illuminates YOUNG EDWARD (12) on his bed. He scrolls endlessly through the void, sad and alone.

EDWARD (V.O.)

I know better now. In the beginning I was carefree, and it felt right. Yet, as life transpired the wicked beliefs of men poisoned my heart. Who I was, wasn't right. Everything I was felt wrong.

He goes to his settings and reluctantly clears his search history.

EDWARD (V.O.)

But, I wasn't repressed growing up. My parents were good people. A *model of marriage*. A frame to keep in mind when building my own family. They were perfect.

SERIES OF FLASHBACKS:

INT. BAR - TWENTY YEARS AGO

TREVOR (20's) eyes JINNY (20's) at the bar. Jinny's hair reaches the ceiling. The higher the hair, the closer to God. Trevor's hair is combed back. He's handsome and enthralling. He winks and tosses up his hand. She looks away. He buys her a drink.

EDWARD (V.O.)

Young love is fragile. Frail. Hollow. The tongues it speaks in are powerful. If and when you fall in love, the voices will inevitably demand the life of one in return for another.

(MORE)

EDWARD (V.O.) (CONT'D)

One day, it will take what it wants without discrimination. Because falling in love is like making a deal with the devil, and the devil will always come calling for his due.

CUT TO:

INT. A HOSPITAL ROOM - DAY

EDWARD (V.O.)

These coupled souls loved me because I was pure and had potential. My future was hopeful.

A NURSE

Do you have any plans for him?

TREVOR

I'm sorry?

A NURSE

Your baby boy. What do you think he'll become?

Trevor and Jinny look at one another. They say nothing.

EDWARD (V.O.)

I was an optimist to think their souls had the capacity to understand they held in their hands a future. His withered the minute his skin touched the soiled air. Do us a favor. Toss me in the waste basket.

The sound of a flatlining heart rate.

CUT TO BLACK.

EXT. EDWARD'S OLD YARD - TWO YEARS LATER

We see the couple through THE LENS OF AN OLD FILM CAMERA. Jinny hangs onto Trevor's neck.

EDWARD (V.O.)

God had our sanity forbidden the day he consummated their love.

FLASH. He lays a necklace around her neck like lace. FLASH. She kisses his cheek. FLASH. Trevor turns and kisses her lips. FLASH. He picks Jinny up bridal style. FLASH.

EDWARD (V.O.)
You're in love, you liars. Love him
unconditionally, lest he leave both
of us. He'll take everything. He'll
take him, just to spite you.

Edward, a toddler, waddles into the view of the lens. Trevor picks him up and the couple hug him. FLASH.

CUT TO:

INT. EDWARD'S OLD KITCHEN - A DECADE LATER

EDWARD (V.O.)
They tried their best.

Trevor fights with Jinny across the kitchen. Young Edward appears, screaming at the two of them. Trevor picks up anything he can find, forks, butter knives, and throws them at Young Edward. He dodges. They miss. He runs back to his room.

EDWARD (V.O.)
But they smashed worlds to pieces
trying to destroy each other.
Volatile and violent. They're
endless in their pursuit of self
destruction.

Jinny backs Trevor against the door as she fights for her child. She streams tears. Trevor gives up and leaves the house slamming the door behind him.

EDWARD (V.O.)
From what I see, their best wasn't
worth shit. I thought that only the
youth could be so easily corrupted.
Only I could fuck up my life before
it even began. Surely, at some
point, you grow the fuck up and
stop making choices that'll damn
you. Choices that are detrimental
not only to your future, but to
that of your kid's.

QUICK SHOTS:

- Young Edward faces first in his pillow. He hears the door slam and jolts.

EDWARD (V.O.)
I used to want kids.

- Jinny retreats from the kitchen.
- Trevor plops a suitcase down on a hotel bed and unlatches it.
- Jinny appears in Edward's doorway, alone, arms folded, and broken. He turns to face her and they grimace at one another.
- Trevor puts away his clothes and takes off his wedding ring.
- Jinny mouths "I'm sorry," and closes Edward's door.
- Trevor sips a beer at an upscale bar. He sits between a man and a woman. He's clearly focused on one of them, probably both of them. He can't decide.

EDWARD (V.O.)
Then I learned about the
perpetuation of selfishness.

- Jinny goes to turn off her bedside lamp, but leaves it on.

EDWARD (V.O.)
They say mother knows best, even
when she hasn't the faintest clue
of what to do to save her soul.

- Trevor is now considerably more drunk. The woman has moved on to someone else, but still eyes him.

EDWARD (V.O.)
And I believe dad knows how to take
what he wants. He'll lose
everything trying to pursue all of
it.

- Jinny curls up into a ball, eyes wide open, wondering.

EDWARD (V.O.)
(again)
I used to want kids.

END QUICK SHOTS.

CUT TO BLACK.

EDWARD (V.O.)
But fuck them kids.

INT. HOTEL BEDROOM - NIGHT

A lamp springs to life. SCAN ACROSS: an exposed built back laying in a hotel bed that may **or may not** belong to Trevor.

CU: on two hands fumbling around with each other. The sex the hands belong to is indeterminant. ON THE BEDSIDE: sits two wedding bands.

EDWARD (V.O.)

I subscribed to their belief that they had never sinned like I had. Naturally, in their mind, none of the minor sins they committed played a major role in who I am. They didn't shape me. I'm my own product and responsible for whatever fucked up variables I decide to pursue.

END FLASHBACKS

INT. JACE'S LIVING ROOM - NIGHT (THE PRESENT)

Open room concept. The wall to the outside is open, letting in the world and a cool breeze. Jinny, now considerably aged by her shitty excuse of a marriage, pours herself a glass of wine over divorce papers. She inadvertently spills some. JACE (30's), her brother, sits next to her. Dangerously thin, handsome, and ready for fatherhood but childless.

EDWARD (V.O.)

Even if I wanted things to change—

JACE

I don't know why you don't leave his sorry ass.

JINNY

You have no idea.

JACE

Fucking sign them Jinny. The papers are right there.

EDWARD (V.O.)

They never will.

Jace pulls out a pack of smokes. He sticks a cigarette between his teeth without lighting it.